have remained entrenched in Chinese attitudes.

As pointed out earlier, Chinese popular attitudes towards India and Indians during this period were influenced by the use of Indian soldiers and policemen in the British depredations in China. In a Chinese novel from 1904, quoted by T.H. Barrett, a British scholar specializing in Chinese studies, we have the following passage:

> Shibao looked closely at these people and they all had faces black as coal. They were wearing a piece of red cloth around their heads like a tall hat; around their waists they wore a belt holding wooden clubs. Shibao asked the old man: are these Indians? The old man said yes, the English use them as policemen. Shibao asked, why do they not use an Indian as the chief of police? The old man answered: Who ever heard of that? Indians are people of a lost country; they are no more than slaves. [9]

Later in the story, some of those wearing red hats are seen to be Chinese, and this was warning of what may happen to the Chinese people if they were to fall prey to foreign rule – another example of India serving as a negative example.

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Did things change after India gained independence in 1947 and China achieved liberation in 1949? Did the negative attitudes from the early decades of the twentieth century persist, or was there a change in the Chinese discourse on India? In reviewing India–China relations over the past seven decades, we see the following pattern: When India–China relations are in a positive phase, for whatever reason, there is an invariable harking back to the shared Buddhist heritage and the history of dense trade and cultural exchanges. There may also be references to mutual sympathy and support during the more modern period of India's struggle for independence and China's liberation, though the evidence for this is more limited. However, whenever relations have become strained and contentious, the disparaging and negative narratives of the more recent past surface not only in the Chinese media but also in records of Chinese leaders' conversations with foreign interlocutors.

Negative media reports concerning India and Indian leaders are well documented. Before the *Hindi–Chini bhai-bhai* (Indians and Chinese are